SAT identifying sentence errors practice test 1

1. Seventy-five percent of what we perceive as$_A$ taste, especially$_B$ the perception of flavor, is really attributable to one's sense$_C$ of smell$_D$. No error$_E$

2. Development of new drugs often require$_A$ years of$_B$ testing and waiting for$_C$ labeling approval from$_D$ federal regulators. No error$_E$

3. Although research in the earth and environmental sciences has pieced together narratives of ancient and historical environmental changes, but there is$_A$ still much$_B$ left to learn$_C$ about the nature and causes of changing$_D$ climatic conditions through time. No error$_E$

4. During$_A$ the reign of Elizabeth I, dozens of commissions were sent out by the central government to investigate$_B$ the wood shortage around the nation, each one$_C$ confirmed the serious$_D$ decline of the forests. No error$_E$

5. While$_A$ sperm whales are usually seen$_B$ in offshore waters, they can also be found near the shore, where$_C$ the continental or island shelf is narrow and with$_D$ the water is deep. No error$_E$

6. A farmer's field can have more than 50,000 weed seeds per square meter$_A$ buried beneath the soil surface seeds$_B$ buried more than about one centimeter below$_C$ the soil surface do not receive enough$_D$ light to germinate. No error$_E$

7. In 1952, when the Federal Communications Commission lifted its ban on new television stations, there were$_A$ 105 stations and 15 million households with television sets, but by$_B$ 1956 the number of stations had grown$_C$ to almost 500 and the number of households with sets at nearly$_D$ 35 million. No error$_E$

8. Halley's comet is a potato-shaped lump about ten miles long$_A$ with a mass$_B$ estimated at$_C$ 10 billion tons, most of which$_D$ is water ice. No error$_E$

9. The Neuse River in North Carolina is thought to be$_A$ about two million years old, and there has$_B$ likely been human settlements in the basin for$_C$ at least$_D$ 14,000 years. No error$_E$

10. Shortly after$_A$ Queen Eleanor arrived in Nottingham in 1257 for a visit$_B$, she fled the town because she could$_C$ not stand the smell of coal smoke and was afraid$_D$ and feared for her health. No error$_E$

11. The great white shark is the more infamous$_A$ of all sharks$_B$, the star of$_C$ Peter Benchley's bestselling novel Jaws, four Hollywood movies, and many$_D$ television specials. No error$_E$

12. The San Andreas Fault in California is just$_A$ one section to$_B$ an active circle of earthquake zones and volcanoes known as$_C$ the "Ring of Fire" that surrounds$_D$ the Pacific Ocean. No error$_E$

13. Relying on dams for large-scale water storage and for$_A$ delivering water to places where$_B$ it does not naturally occur have$_C$ long-term effects on the balance between$_D$ groundwater and surface water and on the quality of the surrounding soil. No error$_E$

14. Despite$_A$ a protest by$_B$ 300 angry drivers, the five members of the bridge authority voted unanimously$_C$ to raise$_D$ the passenger-car toll on the bridge from $1.00 to $2.00. No error$_E$.

SAT identifying sentence errors practice test 2

1. Harpsichords, their sound made by quills plucking strings that are stretche$_{DA}$ over a soundboard, dominated European music in$_B$ the 1700's, they$_C$ were replaced late in the century by the fortepiano, in which$_D$ hammers struck the strings. No error$_E$

2. Vanilla is currently$_A$ one of the most$_B$ popular of all$_C$ spices and flavorings, and is found not only in foodstuffs and also$_D$ in perfumes and cosmetics. No error$_E$

3. The electricity transmission grid consisting$_{A}$ of 200,000 miles of high-voltage lines that carry$_{B}$ power across the United States, northern Mexico, and most of Canada, a grid divided into two$_{C}$ loosely connected$_{D}$ sections called interconnects. No error$_{E}$

4. The first signs in six months of a pickup in consumer spending are emerging$_{A}$, which reduces$_{B}$ the chances that$_{C}$ the Federal Reserve will lower interest rates when it meets$_{D}$ next month. No error$_{E}$

5. The explosions of the volcano Krakatoa in 1883 hurled rock and ash more than$_{A}$ 20 miles high, and it$_{B}$ could be hear$_{DC}$ 3,000 miles away$_{D}$. No error$_{E}$

6. During$_{A}$ the whole period of the westward overland emigration from 1840 an$_{DB}$ 1860, well over half of the emigrants' wagons were pulle$_{DC}$ by$_{D}$ oxen. No error$_{E}$

7. The steam-propelled locomotive on rails was invente$_{DA}$ in$_{B}$ the early nineteenth century by George Stephenson moving$_{C}$ coal from the coal mines near Newcastle, England, to shipping stations on the nearby$_{D}$ Tyne River. No error$_{E}$

8. Each year the television industry takes in billions of dollars in advertising$_{A}$ revenue annually$_{B}$ based on ratings information, but$_{C}$ it can owe advertisers tens of millions of dollars in free commercials when$_{D}$ ratings fall short of expectations. No error$_{E}$

9. No one is exactly sure when$_{A}$ modern rain forests first appeare$_{DB}$, an$_{DC}$ fossil evidence suggests that they were already present at the end of$_{D}$ the age of the dinosaurs, some 60 million years ago. No error$_{E}$

10. Crocodiles spend much$_{A}$ of their lives in the water, but as$_{B}$ turtles, they must lay their eggs on lan$_{DC}$, because$_{D}$ reptile embryos must respirate through the egg's permeable shell. No error$_{E}$

11. In 1996 the town of Amherst, Massachusetts, installed a public sculpture in honor of$_{A}$ its$_{B}$ two most$_{C}$ celebrated$_{D}$ literary residents -- Emily Dickinson and Robert Frost. No error$_{E}$

12. One usually$_{A}$ thinks of a sword as a long strip of metal, either$_{B}$ iron or steel, with a handle, an$_{DC}$ the first swords were made of$_{D}$ wood. No error$_{E}$

13. Elephants use various$_{A}$ methods to combat excessive heat, such as fanning themselves$_{B}$ with their ears and to protect$_{C}$ their skin from the sun with layers$_{D}$ or mud and dust. No error$_{E}$

14. Beginning in the 1830's, walking footraces in England, the United States, and continental Europe became mass spectator sports that$_{B}$ sometimes attract$_{C}$ over$_{D}$ 25,000 people. No error$_{E}$

SAT identifying sentence errors practice test 3

1. More than a century ago, when mail-order catalogs afforded them$_{A}$ who live$_{DB}$ outside of$_{C}$ the big cities their first major glimpse of a growing$_{D}$ new world of consumer goods, many people called them dream books. No error$_{E}$

2. The fish called menhaden are silvery in color an$_{DA}$ a distinct black shoulder spot behin$_{DB}$ their gill opening and a variable$_{C}$ number of smaller spots on$_{D}$ their sides. No error$_{E}$

3. Invente$_{D}$ in$_{A}$ London in 1906, the permanent wave, or perm as it became$_{B}$ known, required a combination of borax paste and heavy brass rollers weighing up to$_{C}$ two pounds each, and they needed$_{D}$ six hours to set. No error$_{E}$

4. Much$_{A}$ of our knowledge of$_{B}$ ancient Egypt has been$_{C}$ derived from scenes carved and painted on the stone walls of tombs and temples and$_{D}$ from artifacts buried in the tombs. No error$_{E}$

5. In the fifteenth century, Leonardo da Vinci suggested that defective vision can be correcte$_{DA}$ by placing$_{B}$ a lens in direct contact$_{C}$ with$_{D}$ the eye. No error$_{E}$

6. The two centers of the immense$_{A}$ biological diversity on Earth are tropical ecosystems, which support$_{B}$ almost unbelievable$_{C}$ large numbers of plants and animals, and islands, which by their isolation$_{D}$ promote the rapid evolution of unique life forms. No error$_{E}$

7. At$_{A}$ Chaco Canyon in the San Juan Basin, Anasazi people constructed large towns, they congregate$_{DB}$ in large communities, and left behin$_{DC}$ spectacular$_{D}$ ruins. No error$_{E}$

8. The same as$_{A}$ land plants depend on$_{B}$ minerals in the soil for$_{C}$ their growth, so marine plants are dependent upon$_{D}$ the nutrient salts or minerals in the sea water. No error$_{E}$

9. By next year the old vaudeville theater had been$_{A}$ converted into two small$_{B}$ theaters in which$_{C}$ films can be shown$_{D}$. No error$_{E}$

10. Some scholars studying$_{A}$ the writings of Emily Bronte have become$_{B}$ increasingly$_{C}$ interested in the relationships between her siblings and she$_{D}$. No error$_{E}$

11. At the 1984 Olympic Games, John Moffet and Pablo Morales, who$_{A}$ were$_{B}$ swimmers on the United States team, set$_{C}$ world records$_{D}$. No error$_{E}$

12. Both Dorothy Sayers plus$_{A}$ Carolyn Heilbrun have written$_{B}$ scholarly works as well as$_{C}$ popular murder mysteries, demonstrating a diversity of$_{D}$ talents and interests. No error$_{E}$

13. Although$_{A}$ the coach had predicted that$_{B}$ the team would have a winning season, the fans were$_{C}$ surprised by the success of$_{D}$ the young, inexperienced players. No error$_{E}$

14. Because they must compete$_{A}$ with a large chain of super-stores that can afford to charge very low rates for certain items, the owners of small hardware stores know that you$_{B}$ are unlikely to make much$_{C}$ profit and may$_{D}$, in fact, go bankrupt. No error$_{E}$

SAT identifying sentence errors practice test 4

1. Although science offers the hope of preventing$_{A}$ serious genetic diseases, there is$_{B}$ difficult ethical questions raised by$_{C}$ the possibility of$_{D}$ altering human heredity. No error$_{E}$

2. In the nineteenth century, careers in business and law were$_{A}$ prestigious, but it$_{B}$ did not require$_{C}$ practitioners to hold$_{D}$ college degrees. No error$_{E}$

3. Chess players find that playing against a computer is helpful to improve$_{A}$ their$_{B}$ skills, even though$_{C}$ no chess-playing computer has yet won$_{D}$ a championship. No error$_{E}$

4. Reaching$_{A}$ lengths of twelve inches, banana slugs are$_{B}$ the much larger$_{C}$ of all the slug species that inhabit$_{D}$ North America. No error$_{E}$

5. Maya Madera proudly$_{A}$ wore her sister's most popular invention, a watch$_{B}$ for winter campers that flashes the temperature in$_{C}$ lighted numerals and sends out a loud alarm when pressing a button$_{D}$. No error$_{E}$.

6. Obviously$_{A}$, Whistler's paintings, unlike Klee$_{B}$, are conventional in$_{C}$ their$_{D}$ subject matter. No error$_{E}$

7. A newly formed organization of homeowners and business people have met with$_{A}$ the transportation department to voice$_{B}$ its concerns about$_{C}$ plans for$_{D}$ a shopping mall in the community. No error$_{E}$

8. Although$_{A}$ she considers her chemistry research complete$_{B}$, she has heeded$_{C}$ her professor's advice and is conducting$_{D}$ three additional experiments. No error$_{E}$

9. Princeton University officials first broke with$_{A}$ a tradition of awarding$_{B}$ honorary degrees only to men$_{C}$ when they awarded it$_{D}$ to author WillCather. No error$_{E}$

10. His love of politics led$_{A}$ him$_{B}$ to volunteer in local campaigns as well$_{C}$ as a job$_{D}$ in a government office in the state capital. No error$_{E}$

11. Now that Michiko finished$_{A}$ the research, she feels reasonably confident$_{B}$ about writing$_{C}$ her paper on the rise of$_{D}$ the progressive movement in the United States. No error$_{E}$

12. The condition known as laryngitis usually causes$_{A}$ the vocal cords and surrounding tissue to swell, thus$_{B}$ preventing the cords to move$_{C}$ freely$_{D}$. No error$_{E}$

13. For$_A$ the cyclist exploring Ireland's western cliffs, every road leading out of$_B$ the town of Clifden offers their$_C$ own$_D$ set of wonders. No error$_E$

14. The construction of a waterway linking the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans was first proposed$_A$ in 1524, but not until$_B$ the Panama Canal opened in 1914 did such a project$_C$ become a reality$_D$. No error$_E$

SAT identifying sentence errors practice test 5

1. The charm of$_A$ Lofting's book lies in$_B$ the humorous reversal of$_C$ roles—the animals guide, assist, and generally they take$_D$ care of the helpless humans. No error$_E$

2. People were trained to perform$_A$ one tiny part of one process in one department of one industry, and so having$_B$ no sense of$_C$ the process as a whole$_D$. No error$_E$

3. The Stegosaurus, plant-eating dinosaurs$_A$ with protective$_B$ bony plates and tail spikes, was once common in$_C$ what is now$_D$ Colorado. No error$_E$

4. Some plants use chemical signals that repel$_A$ insects, and also, these$_B$ signals help to put neighboring plants on alert so they can$_C$ mount their own defenses$_D$. No error$_E$

5. Innovative use of computers in the classroom allows students to undertake$_A$ projects that encourages$_B$ them$_C$ to be both$_D$ analytical and intellectually adventurous. No error$_E$

6. When one is researching$_A$ the customs of a com-munity, you$_B$ must learn about$_C$ its history and observe its people going about their$_D$ ordinary activities. No error$_E$

7. Working with$_A$ consummate skill, Picasso sketched a portrait of$_B$ the youthful but$_C$ experienced dancer who was posing for$_D$ him. No error$_E$

8. From 1566 until$_A$ 1576 Santa Elena, now an excavation site$_B$ in South Carolina, was the capital of Spanish Florida; however$_C$, it has become$_D$ an English settlement by 1735. No error$_E$

9. Despite$_A$ the attorney's moving plea, the judge placed$_B$ the juvenile offender on$_C$ probation for an indecisive$_D$ period. No error$_E$

10. Yearning for$_A$ a truly representative$_B$ art form of the Americas, the art world of the 1920's looked hopefully$_C$ to the three popular Mexican mural artists of the day$_D$. No error$_E$

11. There has always been a great deal of$_A$ friction between Joan and I$_B$ because we$_C$ have opposing political views about which$_D$ we are very vocal. No error$_E$

12. When$_A$ M. R. Harrington, an archaeologist from the Museum of the American Indian, began to excavate$_B$ the ruins he named$_C$ the Pueblo Grande de Nevada, he unearthed artifacts indicating$_D$ a 500-year occupation by indigenous peoples. No error$_E$

13. The supervisor cited three workers, each of which$_A$ is likely to$_B$ win a prize for having suggested$_C$ cost-effective changes atD the factory. No error$_E$

14. Freedom of action and expression are$_A$ at the foundation not only of$_B$ our system of government but also of our expectations concerning$_C$ human relations at all$_D$ levels of society. No error$_E$

Solution

Practice Test 01

1. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: Seventy-five percent of what we perceive as taste, especially the perception of flavor, is really attributable to our sense of smell.

Explanation for Correct Answer C : The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where there is an unnecessary shift in pronoun, from the first-person plural "we" to the indefinite "one."

2. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: Development of new drugs often requires years of testing and waiting for labeling approval from federal regulators.

Explanation for Correct Answer A : The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where there is subject-verb disagreement. The plural verb "require" does not agree with its singular subject, "Development."

3. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: Although research in the earth and environmental sciences has pieced together narratives of ancient and historical environmental changes, there is still much left to learn about the nature and causes of changing climatic conditions through time.

Explanation for Correct Answer A : The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where there is redundancy. The opening word of the sentence, "Although," signals a contrast between its clause and the clause to follow. Therefore, "but, " another contrast word, is not needed because the contrast has already been created by "Although."

4. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: During the reign of Elizabeth I, dozens of commissions were sent out by the central government to investigate the wood shortage around the nation, and each one confirmed the serious decline of the forests.

Explanation for Correct Answer C : The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where there is improper coordination. Two independent clauses ("dozens of commissions...around the nation" and "each one...forests") are connected by only a comma, without the conjunction "and" to introduce the second independent clause.
5. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: While sperm whales are usually seen in offshore waters, they can also be found near the shore, where the continental or island shelf is narrow and the water is deep.

Explanation for Correct Answer D : The error in this sentence occurs at (D), where there is an error in parallelism. The coordinating conjunction "and" requires that the grammatical structures on either side of it be parallel. A clause ("the continental or island shelf is narrow") precedes "and," so another clause ("the water is deep") should follow it.
6. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: A farmer's field can have more than 50,000 weed seeds per square meter buried beneath the soil; surface seeds buried more than about one centimeter below the soil surface do not receive enough light to germinate.

Explanation for Correct Answer B : The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is a lack of punctuation between two sentences. "Surface seeds...below the soil surface" is a new subject, and "do not receive" is a new verb, so a new independent clause is present. But no punctuation or conjunction separates this new clause from the preceding independent clause, resulting in a run-on sentence.
7. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: In 1952, when the Federal Communications Commission lifted its ban on new television station licenses, there were 105 stations and 15 million households with television sets, but by 1956 the number of stations had grown to almost 500 and the number of households with sets to nearly 35 million.

Explanation for Correct Answer D : The error in the sentence occurs at (D), where there is an improper idiom. The coordinating conjunction "and" requires parallel grammatical structures on either side of it, so the phrase "at nearly 35 million" should be "to nearly 35 million," to be parallel with the phrase that precedes "and" ("to almost 500").
8. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Skill: Because this sentence is correct as written, none of the four writing skills can be appropriately assigned to this question.

Corrected Sentence: Halley's comet is a potato-shaped lump about ten miles long with a mass estimated at 10 billion tons, most of which is water ice.

Explanation for Correct Answer E : There is no error in this sentence.
9. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: The Neuse River in North Carolina is thought to be about two million years old, and there have likely been human settlements in the basin for at least 14,000 years.

Explanation for Correct Answer B : The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is a lack of agreement between subject and verb. The plural noun "human settlements" requires the plural verb "have," not "has."
10. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: Shortly after Queen Eleanor arrived in Nottingham in 1257 for a visit, she fled the town because she could not stand the smell of coal smoke and feared for her health.

Explanation for Correct Answer D : The error in this sentence occurs at (D). The verb phrase "was afraid" is redundant with "and feared for." It should be deleted from the sentence.
11. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Skill: Managing grammatical structures used to modify or compare

Corrected Sentence: The great white shark is the most infamous of all sharks, the star of Peter Benchley's bestselling novel Jaws, four Hollywood movies, and many television specials.

Explanation for Correct Answer A : The error in this sentences occurs at (A), where there is an incorrect adjective form. The prepositional phrase "of all sharks" calls for the superlative form of the adjective ("most") rather than the comparative form "more," which would be appropriate if only two sharks were being compared.
12. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: The San Andreas Fault in California is just one section of an active circle of earthquake zones and volcanoes known as the "Ring of Fire" that surrounds the Pacific Ocean.

Explanation for Correct Answer B : The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is a use of an improper idiom. The preposition "to" is used to follow the noun "section" where it would be more idiomatic to use the preposition "of."

13. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: Relying on dams for large-scale water storage and for delivering water to places where it does not naturally occur has long-term effects on the balance between groundwater and surface water and on the quality of the surrounding soil.

Explanation for Correct Answer C : The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where there is lack of subject-verb agreement. The subject of the verb is "relying," so a singular verb, "has," is required.
14. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Skill: Because this sentence is correct as written, none of the four writing skills can be appropriately assigned to this question.

Corrected Sentence: Despite a protest by 300 angry drivers, the five members of the bridge authority voted unanimously to raise the passenger-car toll on the bridge from $1.00 to $2.00.

Explanation for Correct Answer E : There is no error in this sentence.

Practice Test 02

1. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: Harpsichords, their sound made by quills plucking strings that are stretched over a soundboard, dominated European music in the 1700's; they were replaced late in the century by the fortepiano, in which hammers struck the strings.

Explanation for Correct Answer C : The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where faulty coordination occurs. The sentence's two independent clauses ("Harpsichords...1700's" and "they...strings") are joined by only a comma. The comma should be replaced with a (or semicolon), punctuation that can stand alone between two independent clauses.
2. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Skill: Managing grammatical structures used to modify or compare

Corrected Sentence: Vanilla is currently one of the most popular of all spices and flavorings and is found not only in foodstuffs but also in perfumes and cosmetics.

Explanation for Correct Answer D : The error in this sentence occurs at (D), where the second half of the correlative conjunction "not only...but also" should appear, but "and also" appears instead.

3. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: The electricity transmission grid consists of 200,000 miles of high-voltage lines that carry power across the United States, northern Mexico, and most of Canada, a grid divided into two loosely connected sections called interconnects.

Explanation for Correct Answer A : The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where the participle "consisting" is wrongly used as the main verb of the sentence. A participle cannot function as the main verb of a sentence, so the result is a sentence fragment.
4. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Skill: Managing grammatical structures used to modify or compare

Corrected Sentence: The first signs in six months of a pickup in consumer spending are emerging, reducing the chances that the Federal Reserve will lower interest rates when it meets next month.

Explanation for Correct Answer B : The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where the participial "reducing" should appear, but the relative phrase "which reduces" appears instead.
5. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: The explosions of the volcano Krakatoa in 1883 hurled rock and ash more than 20 miles high and could be heard 3,000 miles away.

Explanation for Correct Answer B : The error in this sentence occurs at (B). The pronoun "it" refers incorrectly to the "the volcano Krakatoa," which cannot logically "be heard" from "3,000 miles away."
6. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: During the whole period of the westward overland emigration from 1840 to 1860, well over half of the emigrants' wagons were pulled by oxen.

Explanation for Correct Answer B : The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is an improper idiom. The preposition "from" calls for the preposition "to" to follow it (from 1840 to 1860). Instead, the conjunction "and" is used, incorrectly.
7. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: The steam-propelled locomotive on rails was invented in the early nineteenth century by George Stephenson, moving coal from the coal mines near Newcastle, England, to shipping stations on the nearby Tyne River.

Explanation for Correct Answer C : The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where the verb "moving" is not punctuated, creating confusion as to its subject. The verb phrase (beginning with "moving") should be set off from the first part of the sentence with a comma, to show that the verb's subject is "locomotive" and not "George Stephenson."
8. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: Each year the television industry takes in billions of dollars in advertising revenue based on ratings information, but it can owe advertisers tens of millions of dollars in free commercials when ratings fall short of expectations.

Explanation for Correct Answer B : The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is redundancy. The sentence's opening phrase establishes that the action in the sentence occurs "each year," so the word "annually," which means "each year," is redundant and should be deleted.
9. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: No one is exactly sure when modern rain forests first appeared, but fossil evidence suggests that they were already present at the end of the age of the dinosaurs, some 60 million years ago.

Explanation for Correct Answer C : The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where the contrast in ideas between the sentence's two main clauses should be shown by a contrastive conjunction such as "but" or "yet." Instead, the conjunction "and" is used, which fails to show the contrast in ideas.
10. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Skill: Managing grammatical structures used to modify or compare

Corrected Sentence: Crocodiles spend much of their lives in the water, but like turtles, they must lay their eggs on land, because reptile embryos must respirate through the egg's permeable shell.

Explanation for Correct Answer B : The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is a misleading and illogical use of the word "as." "As" can function as a preposition in some situations, but in this sentence it yields the illogical meaning that "as turtles, they" (crocodiles) "must lay their eggs on land." To clearly convey the intended comparison between crocodiles and turtles, the preposition "like" should be used instead.
11. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Skill: Because this sentence is correct as written, none of the four writing skills can be appropriately assigned to this question.

Corrected Sentence: In 1996 the town of Amherst, Massachusetts, installed a public sculpture in honor of its two most celebrated literary residents -- Emily Dickinson and Robert Frost.

Explanation for Correct Answer E : There is no error in this sentence.
12. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: One usually thinks of a sword as a long strip of metal, either iron or steel, with a handle, but the first swords were made of wood.

Explanation for Correct Answer C : The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where there is an inappropriate connective. The coordinate conjunction "and" does not fit in this context. Instead, the conjunction "but" is needed to indicate the contrast between the two ideas.
13. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: Elephants use various methods to combat excessive heat, such as fanning themselves with their ears and protecting their skin from the sun with layers of mud and dust.

Explanation for Correct Answer C : The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where there is an incorrect verb form. The infinitive ("to protect") is used where the gerund "protecting" is needed to parallel "fanning."
14. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: Beginning in the 1830's, walking footraces in England, the United States, and continental Europe became mass spectator sports that sometimes attracted over 25,000 people.

Explanation for Correct Answer C : The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where there is an incorrect verb tense. The action of the sentence takes place in the past, so the past-tense verb "attracted" should be used in place of the present-tense verb "attract."

Practice Test 03

1. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: More than a century ago, when mail-order catalogs afforded those who lived outside of the big cities their first major glimpse of a growing new world of consumer goods, many people called them dream books.

Explanation for Correct Answer A : The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where there is improper pronoun use. The demonstrative pronoun "those" should be used in place of the third-person plural pronoun "them" to indicate which people ("those who lived outside the big cities") got "their first major glimpse of a growing new world of consumer goods."
2. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: The fish called menhaden are silvery in color with a distinct black shoulder spot behind their gill opening and a variable number of smaller spots on their sides.

Explanation for Correct Answer A : The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where a conjunction is used incorrectly in place of a preposition. The preposition "with" is needed to introduce characterisitics of menhaden beyond their "silvery . . . color."
3. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Skill: Managing grammatical structures used to modify or compare

Corrected Sentence: Invented in London in 1906, the permanent wave, or perm as it became known, required a combination of borax paste and heavy brass rollers weighing up to two pounds each, and it needed six hours to set.

Explanation for Correct Answer D : The error in this sentence occurs at (D), where an incorrect pronoun is used. The plural pronoun "they" cannot logically refer to anything else in the sentence. The singular pronoun "it" is needed (to refer correctly to the singular noun "the permanent wave").
4. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Skill: Because this sentence is correct as written, none of the four writing skills can be appropriately assigned to this question.

Corrected Sentence: Much of our knowledge of ancient Egypt has been derived from scenes carved and painted on the stone walls of tombs and temples and from artifacts buried in the tombs.

Explanation for Correct Answer E : There is no error in this sentence.
5. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Skill: Managing word choice and grammatical relationships between words

Corrected Sentence: In the fifteenth century, Leonardo da Vinci suggested that defective vision could be corrected by placing a lens in direct contact with the eye.

Explanation for Correct Answer A : The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where there is an inappropriate verb form. The present-tense auxiliary verb "can" is used, but the past-tense auxiliary verb "could" is needed (to indicate that correcting vision in this way was seen only as a possibility in the fifteenth century).
6. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Skill: Managing grammatical structures used to modify or compare

Corrected Sentence: The two centers of the immense biological diversity on Earth are tropical ecosystems, which support almost unbelievably large numbers of plants and animals, and islands, which by their isolation promote the rapid evolution of unique life forms.

Explanation for Correct Answer C : The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where there is improper use of a modifier. To modify the adjective "large," one must use an adverb ("unbelievably"), not an adjective ("unbelievable").
7. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Skill: Managing phrases and clauses in a sentence

Corrected Sentence: At Chaco Canyon in the San Juan Basin, Anasazi people constructed large towns, congregated in large communities, and left behind spectacular ruins.

Explanation for Correct Answer B : The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is a flaw in parallelism. The pronoun "they" is unecessary and should be removed so that the sentence contains three parallel past-tense verbs ("constructed," "congregated," and "left") describing the activities of the Anasazi at Chaco Canyon.
8. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Skill: Managing grammatical structures used to modify or compare

Corrected Sentence: Just as land plants depend on minerals in the soil for their growth, so marine plants are dependent upon the nutrient salts or minerals in the sea water.

Explanation for Correct Answer A : The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where there is an improper idiom. The phrase "Just as" is needed in place of the awkward and unidiomatic "The same as" to properly introduce the comparison completed by "so marine plants . . . water."
9. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: By next year the old vaudeville theatre will have been converted into two small theaters in which films can be shown.

Explanation for Correct Answer A :

The error in this sentence occurs at (A), which involves an improper sequence of tenses. The pluperfect verb phrase, "had been," does not agree with the phrase "By next year" or with the tense of the verb phrase "can be shown" later in the sentence.
10. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Some scholars studying the writings of Emily Bront. have become increasingly interested in the relationships between her siblings and her.

Explanation for Correct Answer D :

The error in this sentence occurs at (D), where an improper pronoun case is used. The nominative pronoun "she" is used in the prepositional phrase introduced by the word "between" instead of the objective pronoun "her."
11. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence:

Explanation for Correct Answer E :

There is no error in this sentence.
12. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Both Dorothy Sayers and Carolyn Heilbrun have written scholarly works as well as popular murder mysteries, demonstrating a diversity of talents and interests.

Explanation for Correct Answer A :

The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where the idiom is inappropriate. The connecting word "plus" is not the correct term for use in a phrase beginning with "both."
13. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence:

Explanation for Correct Answer E :

There is no error in this sentence.

Explanation for Incorrect Answer A :

There is no error at (A). The subordinating conjunction "Although" properly introduces a subordinate adverbial clause.
14. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Because they must compete with a large chain of superstores that can afford to charge very low rates for certain items, the owners of small hardware stores know that they are unlikely to make much profit and may, in fact, go bankrupt.

Explanation for Correct Answer B :

The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is a shift of pronoun. The second-person pronoun "you" does not agree with the third-person pronoun "they" earlier in the sentence (which in turn refers to the plural subject of the sentence, "owners").

Practice Test 04

1. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Although science offers the hope of preventing serious genetic diseases, there are difficult ethical questions raised by the possibility of altering human heredity.

Explanation for Correct Answer B :

The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is a problem with subject-verb agreement. In this inverted construction, the singular verb "is" does not agree with its plural subject, "questions."
2. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: In the nineteenth century, careers in business and law were prestigious, but they did not require practitioners to hold college degrees.

Explanation for Correct Answer B :

The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where the number of the pronoun is incorrect. The singular pronoun "it" does not agree with the plural noun "careers," to which it refers.
3. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Chess players find that playing against a computer is helpful in improving their skills, even though no chess-playing computer has yet won a championship.

Explanation for Correct Answer A :

The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where an improper idiom is used. The infinitive "to improve" is used in combination with the verb phrase "is helpful," where it would be more idiomatic to use the phrase "in improving."
4. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Reaching lengths of twelve inches, banana slugs are the largest of all the slug species that inhabit North America.

Explanation for Correct Answer C :

The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where the comparative term is incorrect. The phrase "much larger" implies a comparison between only two items, not a comparison of banana slugs with all other slug species in North America.
5. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Maya Madera proudly wore her sister's most popular invention, a watch for winter campers that flashes the temperature in lighted numerals and sends out a loud alarm when one presses a button.

Explanation for Correct Answer D :

The error in this sentence occurs at (D), where modification is improper. The phrase "pressing a button" cannot logically modify the noun just before it, "alarm," or any other word in the sentence.
6. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Obviously, Whistler's paintings, unlike those of Klee, are conventional in their subject matter.

Explanation for Correct Answer B :

The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where the comparison is not logical. Works of art ("Whistler's paintings") are improperly compared with an artist ("Klee").
7. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: A newly formed organization of homeowners and business people has met with the transportation department to voice its concerns about plans for a shopping mall in the community.

Explanation for Correct Answer A :

The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where there is a problem with subject-verb agreement. The plural verb "have" agrees with the interrupting nouns ("homeowners and business people") but not with its singular subject, "organization."
8. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Although she considers her chemistry research complete, she has heeded her professor's advice and is conducting three additional experiments.

Explanation for Correct Answer E :

There is no error in this sentence.
9. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Princeton University officials first broke with a tradition of awarding honorary degrees only to men when they awarded such a degree to author Willa Cather.

Explanation for Correct Answer D :

The error in this sentence occurs at (D), where the pronoun reference is vague. The sentence contains no singular noun to which the pronoun "it" (presumably meaning an honorary degree) can refer.
10. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: His love of politics led him to volunteer in local campaigns as well as to work in a government office in the state capital.

Explanation for Correct Answer D :

The error in this sentence occurs at (D), where there is a flaw in parallelism. The noun phrase "a job" is not parallel with the earlier verbal phrase "to volunteer."
11. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Now that Michiko has finished the research, she feels reasonably confident about writing her paper on the rise of the progressive movement in the United States.

Explanation for Correct Answer A :

The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where the tense sequence is incorrect. The past tense of the verb, "finished," is inappropriate because the adverb "now" indicates action begun in the past but continuing until the present (action described correctly by the present perfect tense).
12. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: The condition known as laryngitis usually causes the vocal cords and surrounding tissue to swell, thus preventing the cords from moving freely.

Explanation for Correct Answer C :

The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where the idiom is inappropriate. After the verbal "preventing" the phrase "to move" is not idiomatic.
13. Correct Answer: C

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: For the cyclist exploring Ireland’s western cliffs, every road leading out of the town of Clifden offers its own set of wonders.

Explanation for Correct Answer C :

The error in this sentence occurs at (C), where the number of the pronoun is incorrect. The plural pronoun "their" does not agree with the singular noun to which it refers, "road."
14. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence:

Explanation for Correct Answer E :

There is no error in this sentence.

Practice Test 05

1. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: The charm of Lofting's book lies in the humorous reversal of roles— the animals guide, assist, and generally take care of the helpless humans.

Explanation for Correct Answer D :

The error in this sentence occurs at (D), where there is a lack of parallelism. The pronoun "they" introduces a clause, breaking the pattern of successive verbs that precedes it.
2. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: People were trained to perform one tiny part of one process in one department of one industry, and so they had no sense of the process as a whole.

Explanation for Correct Answer B :

The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where a failure to maintain parallelism leaves the phrase after the comma incomplete. Since the verbal "having" has no subject, it is not parallel with the earlier clause "People were trained."
3. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: The Stegosaurus, a plant-eating dinosaur with protective bony plates and tail spikes, was once common in what is now Colorado.

Explanation for Correct Answer A :

The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where there is noun-noun disagreement and subject-verb disagreement. The plural noun "dinosaurs" is an improper appositive for the singular subject, "the Stegosaurus," and it does not agree with the singular verb "was."
4. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Some plants use chemical signals that repel insects, and these signals help to put neighboring plants on alert so they can mount their own defenses.

Explanation for Correct Answer B :

The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where the adverb "also," in addition to the conjunction "and," results in wordiness.
5. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Innovative use of computers in the classroom allows students to undertake projects that encourage them to be both analytical and intellectually adventurous.

Explanation for Correct Answer B :

The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is subject-verb disagreement. The singular verb "encourages" does not agree with its plural subject, the relative pronoun "that," which refers to the plural noun "projects."
6. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: When one is researching the customs of a community, one must learn about its history and observe its people going about their ordinary activities.

Explanation for Correct Answer B :

The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is an improper pronoun shift. The person who “is researching” is also the person who “must learn,” and therefore should be referred to by the pronoun “one” rather than by “you.”
7. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence:

Explanation for Correct Answer E :

There is no error in this sentence.
8. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: From 1566 until 1576, Santa Elena, now an excavation site in South Carolina, was the capital of Spanish Florida; however, it had become an English settlement by 1735.

Explanation for Correct Answer D :

The error in this sentence occurs at (D), where the present perfect verb phrase "has become" is used instead of the pluperfect that is needed to describe an action that had taken place "by 1735."
9. Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Despite the attorney's moving plea, the judge placed the juvenile offender on probation for an indefinite period.

Explanation for Correct Answer D :

The error in this sentence occurs at (D), where there is improper diction. The adjective "indecisive" is used where "indefinite" is needed.
10. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence:

Explanation for Correct Answer E :

There is no error in this sentence.
11. Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: There has always been a great deal of friction between Joan and me because we have opposing political views about which we are very vocal.

Explanation for Correct Answer B :

The error in this sentence occurs at (B), where there is an improper pronoun case. The nominative case of the first-person pronoun, "I," is used where the objective case, "me," is needed.
12. Correct Answer: E

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence:

Explanation for Correct Answer E :

There is no error in this sentence.
13. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: The supervisor cited three workers, each of whom is likely to win a prize for having suggested cost-effective changes at the factory.

Explanation for Correct Answer A :

The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where there is an improper use of pronoun. In the phrase "each of which," the pronoun "which" incorrectly refers to a person (one of the "three workers") and should instead be "whom."
14. Correct Answer: A

Explanation:

Corrected Sentence: Freedom of action and expression is at the foundation not only of our system of government but also of our expectations concerning human relations at all levels of society.

Explanation for Correct Answer A :

The error in this sentence occurs at (A), where there is subject-verb disagreement. The plural verb "are" does not agree with the singular subject "freedom."